



Mary E. Rodman Elementary School INSPIRE Meeting Notes

Allendale Community Association Meeting

Mary E. Rodman Recreation Center

Friday, April 5, 2019 at 6:30 PM

What would you like to improve/enhance in your neighborhood?

- Signs for picking up after dog
- Look at dumping/poor condition of city owned vacant lots -lot 035
- Many Unattended Children, not enough parents/supervision
- Need sensitivity advertising/campaign about respecting others property
- Trash
- Speedbumps/Traffic Calming needs at Edgewood, Saratoga, and on Mulberry and Allendale around the recreation center and school
- More police presence
- More lighting- the new lighting does not illuminate-look at Denison and Glen
- Mulberry needs repaving
- Need to add flowers, landscaping, and foliage
- Increase beautification efforts, flowers and landscaping
- Cracked sidewalks
- At the intersection of Mulberry and Allendale there is a dip in the street (Allendale has been newly repaved)
- Need more youth programming
- Basketball court with lights
- Recreation center programming
- Need to look at dying trees in the area especially on Allendale and Edgewood (Tree Inventory of Community)
- Look at rehabbing houses in the ¼ mile
- West Franklin Street Mattress dumping
- Beautify the area besides the cemetery on Edmondson Avenue
- Examine tree root damage in the 400 block of Normandy

Appreciate

- Greenspace



INSPIRE

Investing in Neighborhoods and Schools to Promote
Improvement, Revitalization, and Excellence

Mary E. Rodman Elementary

April 5, 2019



Investing in Schools + Neighborhoods



City Schools, Maryland Stadium Authority, Baltimore City, and the State are investing nearly one billion dollars to renovate or replace schools.

21st Century has 3 goals:

- Transform student opportunities and achievement
- Improve engagement and wellbeing of communities
- **Help revitalize neighborhoods and communities**



The Planning Department launched the INSPIRE program to focus on the neighborhood immediately surrounding each of the 21st Century schools.

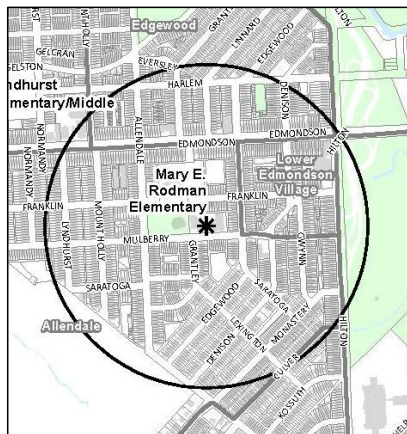
Concentrate improvements around the school:

- Improve the environment and quality of life
- Take concrete action towards the community's long-term vision; guide private investment

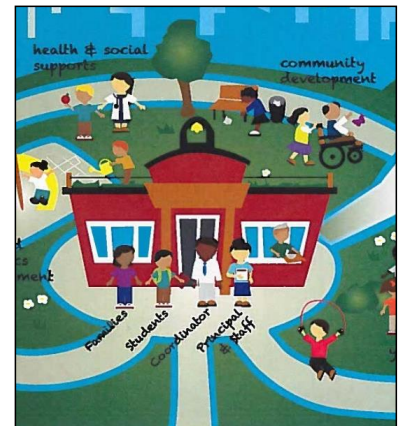
There's a Lot Being Planned/Happening...



School Site



Around the School



Partners & Resources

21st Century Activity Timeframe



Planning



Design



Construction



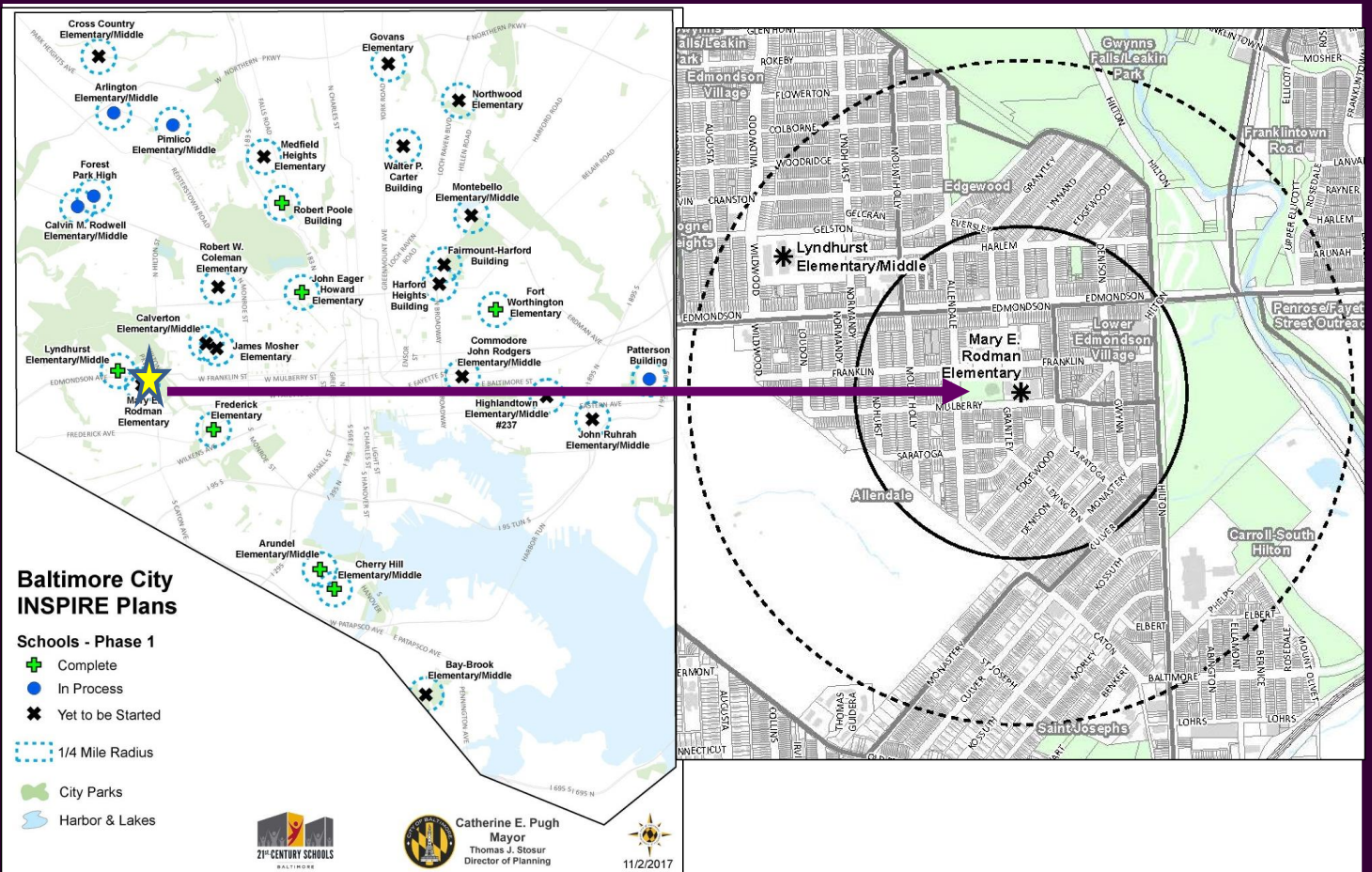
Occupancy

18-24 Months

18-24 Months

INSPIRE Process

Rolling-out INSPIRE Citywide and at Mary E. Rodman



INSPIRE: What It Is (Overview)

- A **plan**
 - Improve quality of life and guide community's long-term vision
 - Recommendations for short-and long-term activities and investments
 - Adopted by the Planning Commission
 - City investments
 - Community-based/public space project
- A **process** to develop and begin to implement the plan
 - Gather information
 - Draft and review recommendations
 - Write, review, and implement

Activities, Investments, Recommendations



Preparing for Opening Day

City agencies have committed to streetscape improvements (sidewalk repairs, crosswalks, street trees, etc.).

Where: Along the Primary Walking Routes



Area-Specific Recommendations

Improvements in the environment and QOL of students, their families, and neighborhood residents/businesses (housing market and development; safety; sanitation; sustainability; health, wellness, and recreation; transportation; and self sufficiency).

Where: Throughout INSPIRE area, nearby



Community-Selected Priority Project

INSPIRE funds implementation of one of the recommendations.

Where: Throughout INSPIRE area

Process = Engagement + Implementation

LISTEN: GATHER INFORMATION

Workshops, Surveys, Steering Committee Involvement,
"Field work" (community walks)

CREATE: DRAFT & REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS

DOP Drafts, City Agency Involvement,
Steering Committee Involvement, Workshops

DELIVER: FINALIZE & IMPLEMENT PLAN

DOP Finalizes , Shares with Community, Presents to Planning
Commission, Implements

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

- INSPIRE Workshops
- Community Meetings & Events
- Steering Committee Meetings
- School Events
- Student Workshops & Projects
- Fieldwork/Community Walks
- Subject-area Workshops
- Project Voting
- Project Charrettes



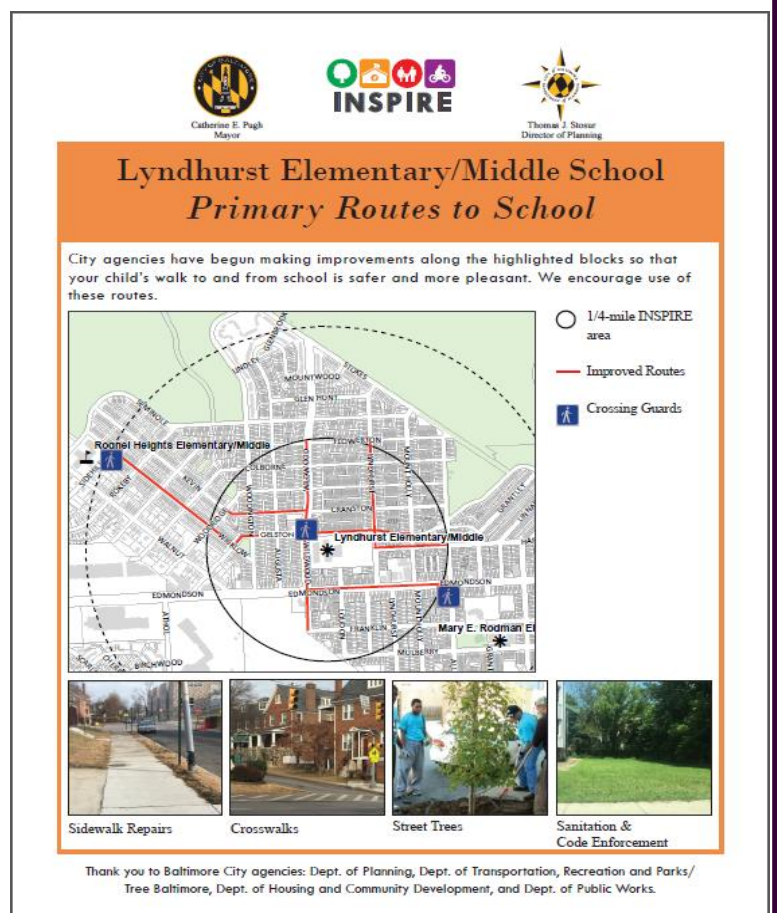
Although much of the plan will be implemented after adoption, there is investment and activity throughout the process.

Recommendations: Primary Walking Routes

Preparing for Opening Day

City agencies have committed to making these improvements:

- Repairing sidewalks
- Repainting or adding crosswalks
- Marking Safe Routes to School
- Assessing crossing guard deployment
- Pruning & planting street trees
- Replacing missing/broken lights
- Boarding open vacant buildings
- Picking up trash and maintaining vacant lots



Recommendations: Half-Mile around the School

- **Housing & Market Strength**: *Have diversity in housing type, housing quality; remove blight; focus on retail and other development*
- **Environmental Sustainability**: *Improve the natural environment*
- **Transportation**: *Connect people to the places they need and want to go*
- **Sanitation**: *Have clean sidewalks, vacant lots, alleys, and other areas*
- **Improve Safety**: *Make people feel and be safe*
- **Health and Wellness**: *Ensure there are places for people to recreate, play, and come together; provide better access to healthy foods*
- **Economic Self-Sufficiency**: *Expand employment and workforce development opportunities*

Implementation: Examples



- A community organization near Arlington Elementary adopted a City-owned lot and is turning it into a community/school garden.



- Frederick Elementary School worked with partners to develop a walking school bus to provide adult leaders to safely guide children to and from school every day.



- Baltimore's Housing and Community Development department is rehabbing City-owned properties directly facing Pimlico Elementary/Middle.



- A master plan is being completed for a park near Dorothy I. Height Elementary. INSPIRE and BRNI funding will implement park plan. Youth artists installed a mural in the park through Art @ Work.

Community-based Priority Projects

Some of the projects being assessed



Fort Worthington:
Community & School Garden



John Eager Howard:
German Park Improvements



Lyndhurst:
Veteran Memorial Garden



Arundel + Cherry Hill:
Landscaped Lot & Path

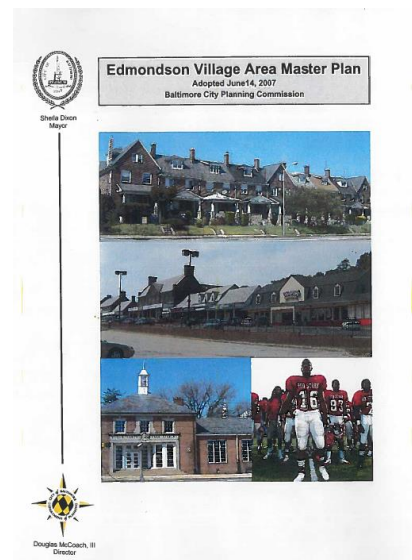
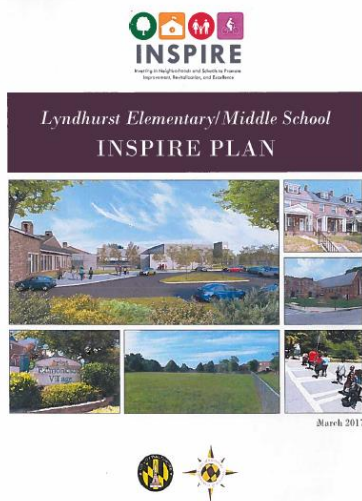


Arlington:
Community Garden

- Murals
- Play Spaces
- Community Signs
- Artistic Fencing
- Traffic Calming
- Façade Improvement
- Public Art
- Community Signs
- More

Review of Plans in the Mary E Rodman Area

- Lyndhurst - Wildwood Elementary Middle School INSPIRE Plan (Adopted March 2017)
- Edmondson Village Area Master Plan (Adopted June 2007)



Discussion

WHAT DO YOU APPRECIATE AND WANT TO ENHANCE IN YOUR NEIGHBORHOOD?

WHAT DO YOU THINK NEEDS WORK IN YOUR NEIGHBORHOOD?

WHAT EVENTS, MEETINGS, OR ACTIVITIES ARE COMING UP THAT WE SHOULD KNOW ABOUT?

INSPIRE Steering Committee

A small Steering Committee of community volunteers will work closely with INSPIRE process and serve as ambassadors.



- **Listen**

- Outreach
- Introductions
- Share important history/priorities
- Community Walks



- **Create**

- Recommendation prioritization and feedback
- ID subject-area workshop interest

- **Deliver**

- Community-based project participation
- Planning Commission participation

Sign up if you're interested in participating!

Questions and Next Steps

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Southwest District Planner

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Community Survey

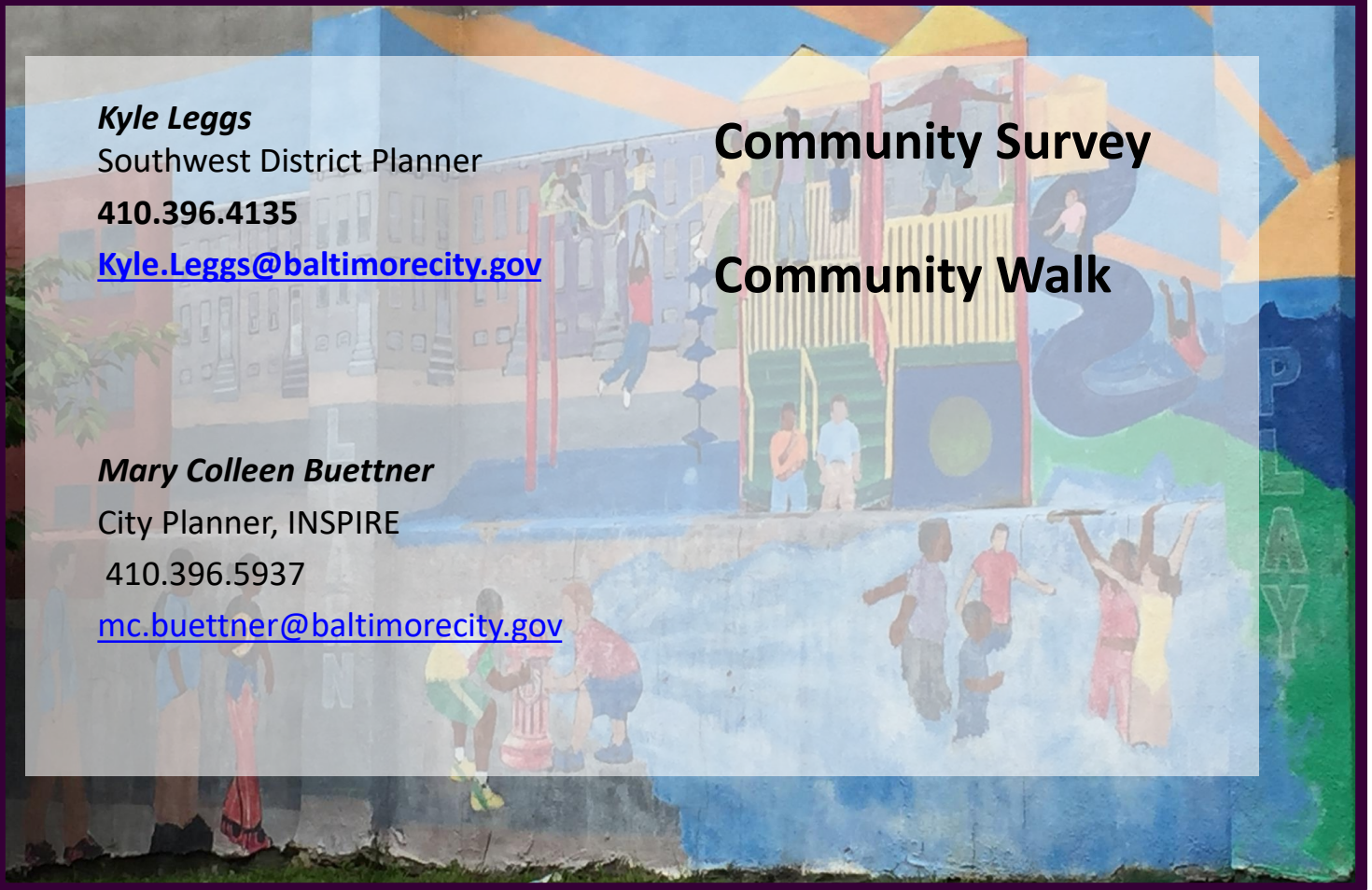
Community Walk

Mary Colleen Buettner

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Mary E. Rodman Elementary School INSPIRE Workshop Meeting Notes

Mary E. Rodman Recreation Center

Saturday, November 23, 2019 at 10:00 AM to Noon

Tell us one thing you like about your neighborhood?

- Appreciate people helping the community
- People grew up here and still live here
- Lots of green space
- Community unity - Bring back standards
- Bring peace back to our neighborhoods
- Appreciate people and SWCDC efforts
- Resident since April 1961 - Appreciate community spirit
- Seeing turn around - Want more trees and trash pick-up
- Like ample green space, gardens
- Like new interior of Allendale – Need to preserve history
- Resident since 1958 – People still live here (Multi-generational)
- Close to DC via rail
- Like greenspace
- Closeness to downtown & I-695
- Need to redevelop Edmondson Village Shopping Center (Recent fire damage to 10 stores)

General comments and questions

- Door hangers are placed on doors advising residents of new tree plantings along student walking routes
- Why letters of support to replant street trees?
- Can you request that a tree not be placed in front of your house? Answer - Yes
- Cost of sidewalk repair is City's responsibility if tree causes damage
- Alleys are used by children as shortcuts – what about their safety?
- City Department of Transportation (DOT) will not pay to repave alleys as walking routes because alleys should not be walking routes
- Today children cross intersections after crossing guards leave

How do we make this community even better?

- Need security cameras along children's walking routes (To prevent kidnapping)
- Make Mulberry Street One Way – Lease parking spaces for teachers at Shopping Center
- Need residents to be ready for changes coming

- Traffic mitigation in front of school at the corner of Denison and Mulberry Streets
- Need more City help for deteriorating properties - Add community service work (Try Civic Works)
- Improve light pole consistency for the entire community
- Complaint inspections are not done – Should be followed up on
- Partner with MICA (Arts College) to bring their students out into the community
- Need more trash sweeping & clean ups
- Put reflectors on signs for more visibility
- Establish new historic designation for the community
- Consider solar powered traffic signals, and perhaps for new building
- Establish Kids Program thru Art with a Heart
- Orchestra Kids Program
- Establish wrap around services – University of MD, Coppin State University (Consider trauma based)
- Need consistent cooperation with Housing Inspectors (Too many 311 calls are not being addressed)
- Trees throughout the community
- Need to clean around the store on Normandy
- More uniform lighting throughout the area
- Consider a median strip at the corners of Denison and Mulberry Street with low lining flowers
- New and consistent signage – Daisy Field
- Increased lighting at Hilton Parkway – Cut back trees on parkway near S. Hilton Street exit
- Police need to direct children as the crossing guards are ignored

Notes from Mapping Exercise (Unmapped comments)

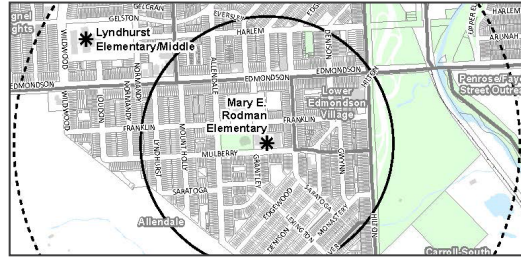
Green Dot = Good things in the community (No unmapped comments)

Red Dot = Bad things in the community

- The intersection of Denison up to Mulberry Street is dangerous – No Stop Bars
- Drivers are driving too fast along main thoroughfares and along W. Mulberry Street

Blue Dot = Vision for the community

- Memorial Park Garden at Gwynns Falls & Franklin Street (Place trees in that area, along with a sitting bench and fountain)
- Playground next to house on Monastery & Gwynn Avenue
- Playground on Loudon & Franklin Street
- More trees where possible interspersed throughout 8th District
- Solar panels on all light poles for reduced electrical expenses
- LED lighting for poles
- Close all liquor stores and convenience stores by 10:00 PM
- Use shuttle buses for teachers to use parking spaces at the Edmondson Village Shopping Center to be bussed back to Mary E. Rodman School (2020 School Year)



Help shape the neighborhood around Mary E. Rodman Elementary School!

Saturday November 23 (10:00am-12:00pm)

Mary E. Rodman Recreation Center • 3600 W. Mulberry Street

The 21st Century renovation of Mary E. Rodman Elementary School provides an opportunity to make other investments in the neighborhood that will positively affect the quality of life for students, their families, and other residents around the school.

Participate in the INSPIRE Community Workshop to:

- **Learn more about INSPIRE**
- **Share your priorities for your community**
- **Suggest ideas for a community project**

Contact Kyle Leggs with questions: (410) 396-4135; kyle.leggs@baltimorecity.gov

INSPIRE is a program of the Baltimore City Department of Planning. <https://planning.baltimorecity.gov/planning-inspire>



**Bring your family and friends.
We'll bring hot coffee and cocoa.**



